



BRAD GARD

KEYNOTE SPEAKER · MASTER ELECTRICIAN · TRAINING DIRECTOR, IBEW LOCAL 120

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LEADERSHIP & MENTORSHIP KEYNOTE

From Tools to Teaching

YOUR BEST TRADESPERSON AND YOUR BEST TEACHER ARE NOT THE SAME PERSON - AND THE GAP IS COSTING YOU.

THE TALK

The trades promote on craft - the best hand becomes the foreperson, the best foreperson becomes the superintendent. But the instincts that make someone brilliant on the tools, speed, precision, solving it themselves, are the exact instincts that make them struggle to grow anyone else. Brad names that trap and shows why so many great workers turn into overloaded, frustrated leaders.

Drawing on four decades in the field and the hard lessons of running his own crews and company, he lays out how skill actually passes from one person to the next, and why the knowledge that matters most is the kind that was never written down. It is a practical, honest talk about becoming the person who builds people, before a generation of expertise walks out the door for good.

WHAT THE ROOM WALKS AWAY WITH

- **Promotion is not development.** Why your best hand needs real training for the new job, not just a new title.
- **The "I'll just do it myself" reflex,** how it quietly stalls everyone around you, and how to break it.
- **Show it, hand it over, step back.** A simple method for transferring real skill.
- **Let them fail small,** so people build judgment without risking safety or the schedule.
- **Correct without crushing,** so your crew keeps trying hard things in front of you.

THE SHIFT THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING

Buried one day, Brad handed a young apprentice a job he would normally have done himself, and nearly took it back a dozen times while he watched. What that one panel taught him reframed how he led for the next twenty years.

THE METHOD

SHOW IT

You do the task, out loud and slow, with them standing right beside you.

HAND IT OVER

They do it; you keep your hands in your pockets and let them work through it.

STEP BACK

They own it, you build the next one, and the skill outlives you both.

IDEAL FOR

Contractors and employers · Foreperson and supervisor development · Apprenticeship and training programs · Union leadership · Any organization promoting technical experts into leadership

FORMATS

Signature keynote	45-60 min
Conference slot	25-30 min
Keynote + leadership workshop	90+ min

Brad Gard - Master Electrician & Training Director, IBEW Local 120. Four decades in the trade, on the tools since fourteen. Recent keynote: NETCO, Charlevoix.

BOOK THIS KEYNOTE

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